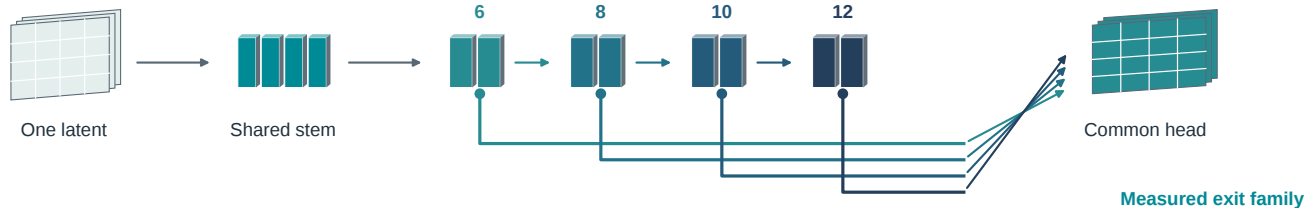


a Shared early exit: one representation, nested synthesis



b Independent depth controls: each codec learns its own representation



Same-recipe D12 is an additional control. The released anchor alone does not isolate depth.

c Later routing study: select before encoding; signal which expert owns the payload

